Minutes of Visitor Services Working Group Meeting No. 5/2026: Cool-Season Readiness

Doi Kham Sai National Park, Nan · Ref. VSWG-05/2026 · Meeting held 24 September 2026 · Minutes approved 29 September 2026

Venue: Visitor Centre Training Room 2, Park Headquarters, 09:30–12:15. **Present:** Sutthida Lertkhamrong (Head of Visitor Services, chair), Thanakorn Panyawai (Campground Supervisor, Pha Mok Ngoen), Rungnapa Bunyasit (Booking and Finance Officer), Somsak Kittichon (Chair, Ban Huai Rin Community Shuttle Group, invited), Natcha Wongpanit (Visitor Centre Assistant, minutes). **Apologies:** Park Superintendent (on leave; decisions in items 3 and 4 to be confirmed by him by 2 October 2026).

1. Previous minutes and review of the 2025–26 season

The minutes of Meeting No. 4/2026 (27 August 2026) were adopted without change. Rungnapa Bunyasit reported that the Pha Mok Ngoen campground received 41,300 overnight campers between 1 November 2025 and 28 February 2026. The busiest night was Saturday 3 January 2026, with 912 campers against a design capacity of about 500. Toilet blocks ran out of water twice that weekend and 37 written complaints were received.

2. Daily camper cap at Pha Mok Ngoen

Last season the cap was 600 campers per night, but it was not enforced for walk-in visitors. The group **agreed a cap of 480 campers per night** for the 2026–27 cool season, from 1 November 2026 to 28 February 2027. Of these places, 400 are sold online through the park booking page and 80 are held for walk-in visitors at the campground gate, sold from 12:00 on the day. Walk-in places are not sold to visitors who arrive after 18:00. Children under 6 years count towards the cap but do not pay the camping fee.

The camping fee stays at 30 baht per person per night for visitors who bring their own tent. Thanakorn Panyawai will mark the tent zones A to F with numbered posts so that rangers can count pitches each evening.

3. Sunrise shuttle to Pha Mok Ngoen viewpoint

From 1 November 2026 to 28 February 2027, private cars and motorcycles may not use the 4.2 km viewpoint road between 04:30 and 08:00. During these hours visitors reach the viewpoint only by the shuttle run by the Ban Huai Rin Community Shuttle Group, which will provide 14 pickup trucks with 10 seats each.

- Departures from the campground stop: 05:00, 05:20 and 05:40. Last return from the viewpoint: 07:45.
- Fare: 60 baht return per adult (last season 50 baht); 30 baht for children aged 6 to 11; free for children under 6 sitting on a lap.
- Tickets are sold only at the campground kiosk the evening before, from 17:00 to 20:30, and are valid for the time printed on them.

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Somsak Kittichon asked that the group keep the full fare. It was agreed that the group keeps all fare income and pays the park a flat concession fee of 1,500 baht per truck for the season, due by 15 November 2026.

> **Note.** Visitors holding a disability parking permit may still drive to the viewpoint during closed hours, but only after registering their vehicle at the campground kiosk the evening before.

4. Tent rental and deposit

The park rents 120 tents at Pha Mok Ngoen. From 1 November 2026 the rental price is 250 baht per night for a 2-person tent and 350 baht per night for a 4-person tent, including a sleeping mat for each person. A cash deposit of 500 baht per tent is taken when the tent is collected and returned when it is handed back clean and undamaged by 10:00 on the departure day.

Agreed rules for keeping the deposit:

1. Tent returned after 10:00 but before 12:00: 100 baht is kept.
2. Tent returned after 12:00: one extra night is charged and taken from the deposit.
3. Torn fly sheet, broken pole or burn mark: the full 500 baht is kept, and the supervisor may charge the repair cost if it is higher.

A tent that is only wet from dew or fog is not treated as damaged. Staff will dry it; no money is kept.

5. Cancellations and weather closures

Rungnapa Bunyasit proposed one rule for online camping and tent bookings, and the group agreed:

- Cancelled 3 days or more before the arrival date: refund of the full amount minus a 40 baht processing fee per booking.
- Cancelled less than 3 days before arrival, or no-show: no refund.
- If the park closes the campground or the viewpoint road for weather or fire risk, every affected booking receives a full refund with no fee, whatever the notice given, or the visitor may move the booking to another date in the same season.

Refunds are paid to the original card or bank account within 15 working days. Personal reasons, including illness, are treated as a normal cancellation.

6. Action points

- Update the booking page with the new cap, prices and cancellation rule by 10 October 2026: Rungnapa Bunyasit.
- Install numbered pitch posts in zones A to F and train kiosk staff by 25 October 2026: Thanakorn Panyawai.
- Send the driver list and copies of vehicle insurance for all 14 trucks by 20 October 2026: Somsak Kittichon.
- Send these minutes to the Park Superintendent for confirmation: Sutthida Lertkhamrong.

Next meeting: Meeting No. 6/2026, Thursday 3 December 2026, 09:30, Visitor Centre Training Room 2.

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